

1. Air Traffic Control (ATC) Instructions & Clearances

- General Instructions:
 - maintain position
 - hold position
 - holding short
 - line up and wait
 - cleared straight in approach
 - continue approach
 - cleared to divert
 - cleared to deviate
 - follow the traffic ahead of you
 - proceed to AFA VOR / AFA VORTAC
 - fly direct
 - resume own navigation
 - resume conventional navigation
 - squawk ident
 - exit hold now
 - expect hold
 - expect circling
 - expect vector to intercept
 - vectors to final approach
 - maintain own separation
 - fly en route
 - maintain rwy heading
 - left hand pattern
 - pattern work
- Speed & Altitude Adjustments:
 - reduce speed to 230 kt
 - reduce speed to mach 0.75
 - descend at your discretion
 - drift down procedure
 - maximum altitude capability
 - leveled at flight level 200
 - steep descent
- Runway Operations:
 - vacate rwy
 - rwy incursion
 - cross rwy
 - back track
 - cleared for immediate takeoff

- immediate takeoff
 - reject take-off
 - going around
 - follow missed approach procedure
 - longest available rwy
 - Approach & Landing:
 - direct approach
 - expect approach
 - expect ILS approach
 - expect RNAV RWY 20 approach
 - straight in approach
 - downwind leg
 - on the visual
 - confirm rwy in sight
 - priority to land
 - number one for landing
 - Taxi Instructions:
 - taxi with caution
 - expedite taxi
 - via taxiway L
 - taxi to gate 5
 - taxi to the ramp
 - approved taxi
 - push back tow truck
 - push back tow bar
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2. Emergencies & Abnormal Situations

- Engine & Systems Failures:
 - engine stall
 - loss of thrust
 - loss of power
 - we lost engine number 1
 - flame out on the right engine
 - an engine flame out
 - engine low oil pressure
 - engine high temperature
 - high oil temperature
 - low oil pressure
 - engine surge

- hydraulic fluid leak
- hydraulic pressure indication is dropping
- total electrical failure
- battery power
- partial panel
- FMS went blank
- GPS inoperative
- electronic navigation capability
- neither of propellers is working
- Landing Gear Issues:
 - main gear is stuck
 - landing gear stuck
 - landing gear bugged down
 - left main landing gear
 - main landing gear collapsed
 - main landing gear retracted
 - main landing gear twisted
 - main landing gear extended
 - wheels up landing
 - belly landing
 - flaps up landing
- Pressurization & Decompression:
 - air cabin depressurization
 - sudden decompression
 - due to pressurization problem
- Fire & Smoke:
 - fire in the hold
 - fire on board
 - fire in the wheel well
 - fire in the catering
 - uncontrollable fire
 - smoke in the cabin
 - fumes in the cabin
- Structural Damage:
 - door separated from the airplane
 - broken windshield
 - cracked windshield
 - cracked windscreen
 - shattered windscreen
 - windscreen damaged
 - it is opened in the front of the plane
 - it is opened in the aft cargo hold

- it is opened in the forward cargo hold
 - Weather-Related Emergencies:
 - thunderstorm
 - severe turbulence
 - moderate turbulence
 - windshear on final
 - microburst on final
 - gust wind on final approach
 - icing conditions
 - de-icing system not working properly
 - Fuel Issues:
 - dump some fuel
 - request fuel dumping
 - facing low fuel
 - facing fuel starvation
 - confirm fuel remaining in hours
 - Other Emergencies:
 - distress call
 - emergency evacuation
 - emergency landing
 - perform an emergency landing
 - emergency services
 - scapes slides accidentally deployed
 - struck by lightning
 - bird strike
 - hit birds
 - flock of birds on final
 - vultures in the vicinity
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3. Passenger & Crew Incidents

- Medical Emergencies:
 - a person passed out
 - the flight attendant has fainted
 - heart attack
 - seizure
 - epileptic attack
 - pilot incapacitated
 - pilot incapacitation
 - food poisoning

- Passenger Behavior:
 - passenger fighting on board
 - passenger misbehavior
 - passengers misconduct
 - unaccompanied minor
 - Crew Communications:
 - flight attendant
 - flight purser
 - stewardess
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4. Ground Operations & Airport Incidents

- Ground Handling:
 - towed
 - disembark passengers
 - give way to the aircraft
 - got stuck
 - maintenance people are on the way
 - ground staff on the way
 - fire fighters are on the way
 - airport authority
 - work in progress
 - debris on the taxiway
 - wreckage on the RWY
 - FOD was reported
 - drone near the airport
 - collision with a tow truck
 - loose dog on board
 - Parking & Startup:
 - return to the parking
 - start up at 60
 - start up and pushback approved
 - operations closed
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5. Navigation & Communication

- Radio & Transmission Issues:
 - radar contact lost
 - radio contact lost

- loss of radio contact
 - transmission is readable
 - transmission is poor
 - readability is poor
 - transmission is blocked
 - message was blocked
 - message was garbled
 - Navigation Procedures:
 - under visual meteorological conditions
 - under radar vectors
 - expect RNAV approach
 - TOD (top of descent) is close
 - confirm ETA
 - confirm diversion
 - confirm deviation
 - confirm detour due to bad weather
 - deviation to avoid weather
 - restricted area
 - military activity
 - Instrumentation Issues:
 - altimeter setting
 - disagreement in the altimeters
 - rate of descent
 - present heading
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6. Weather & Environmental Conditions

- Weather Reports & Advisories:
 - shower over the field
 - weather is deteriorating rapidly
 - expect moderate turbulence
 - expect severe turbulence
 - Visual Observations:
 - hot air balloon at 12 o'clock
 - hot air balloon at 6 o'clock
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7. Cargo & Special Situations

- Cargo Operations:

- cargo apron
 - dangerous goods on board
 - hazmat on board
 - human organ for transplant
 - Aircraft Weight & Balance:
 - number of persons on board
 - confirm people on board
 - confirm souls on board
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8. General Aviation & Miscellaneous

- Balloon Operations:
 - hot air balloon
- Pilot Reports & Requests:
 - need assistance
 - assistance upon arrival
 - at your discretion
 - confirm intentions
 - confirm if the approach is adequate
 - be advised
 - say indicated airspeed
 - copied you lost ailerons
 - read back all information
 - check out the problem
 - looks like I have a failure
 - we are assessing the system

Aviation Phraseology Reference Table

1. Air Traffic Control (ATC) Instructions & Clearances

General Instructions

Term	Example Phrase
maintain position	"Tower, N123AB maintaining position at holding point Alpha."
hold position	"Ground, N456CD holding position at taxiway Bravo."
holding short	"N789EF holding short of runway 27L."
line up and wait	"Tower, N234GH lined up and waiting, runway 36R."
cleared straight in approach	"Approach, N567IJ cleared straight in approach runway 09."
continue approach	"Tower, N890KL continuing approach runway 18."
cleared to divert	"Center, N123LM cleared to divert to alternate airport."
cleared to deviate	"N456NO cleared to deviate left for weather avoidance."

follow the traffic ahead of you	"N789PQ following traffic ahead, visual contact established."
proceed to AFA VOR / AFA VORTAC	"N234QR proceeding direct to AFA VOR."
fly direct	"N567ST flying direct to KXYZ."
resume own navigation	"N890UV resuming own navigation, radar service terminated."
resume conventional navigation	"N123WX resuming conventional navigation, GPS unavailable."
squawk ident	"N456YZ squawking ident for radar identification."
exit hold now	"N789AB exiting hold at waypoint DELTA."
expect hold	"N234CD expecting holding instructions at waypoint ECHO."
expect circling	"N567EF expecting circling approach runway 27."
expect vector to intercept	"N890GH expecting vectors to intercept localizer."
vectors to final approach	"N123IJ requesting vectors for the final approach course."

maintain own separation	"N456KL maintaining own separation in VFR conditions."
fly en route	"N789MN flying en route to destination."
maintain rwy heading	"Tower, N234OP maintaining runway heading after departure."
left hand pattern	"N567QR entering left hand pattern runway 36."
pattern work	"N890ST performing pattern work at KABC."

Speed & Altitude Adjustments

Term	Example Phrase
reduce speed to 230 kt	"N123UV reducing speed to 230 knots."
reduce speed to mach 0.75	"N456WX reducing speed to mach 0.75."
descend at your discretion	"N789YZ descending at pilot's discretion to FL180."
drift down procedure	"N234AB initiating drift down after engine failure."
maximum altitude capability	"N567CD reporting maximum altitude capability FL250."
leveled at flight level 200	"N890EF leveled at flight level 200."

steep descent	"N123GH executing a steep descent for emergency."
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Runway Operations

Term	Example Phrase
vacate rwy	"Tower, N456IJ vacating runway 09 at taxiway Charlie."
rwy incursion	"Ground, possible runway incursion at intersection Delta."
cross rwy	"N789KL requesting to cross runway 18."
back track	"N234MN backtracking runway 27 for departure."
cleared for immediate takeoff	"Tower, N567OP cleared for immediate takeoff runway 36L."
immediate takeoff	"N890QR executing immediate takeoff for emergency."
reject take-off	"Rejecting takeoff at 80 knots!"
going around	"Tower, N456UV going around from runway 09."
follow missed approach procedure	"N789WX following published missed approach procedure."

longest available rwy	"Requesting the longest available runway for emergency landing."
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Approach & Landing

Term	Example Phrase
direct approach	"N234YZ requesting direct approach to runway 15."
expect approach	"N567AB expecting approach clearance in 5 minutes."
expect ILS approach	"N890CD expecting ILS approach runway 28R."
expect RNAV RWY 20 approach	"N123EF expecting RNAV runway 20 approach."
straight in approach	"N456GH requesting straight in approach runway 33."
downwind leg	"N789IJ entering downwind leg for runway 24."
on the visual	"Tower, N234KL on the visual for runway 17."
confirm rwy in sight	"N567MN confirming runway 12 in sight."
priority to land	"N890OP requesting priority to land due to emergency."

number one for landing	"Tower, N123QR number one for landing runway 21."
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Taxi Instructions

Term	Example Phrase
taxi with caution	"Ground, N456ST taxiing with caution for construction."
expedite taxi	"N789UV expediting taxi to runway 31."
via taxiway L	"N234WX taxiing via taxiway Lima to ramp."
taxi to gate 5	"Ground, N567YZ taxiing to gate 5."
taxi to the ramp	"N890AB taxiing to the ramp."
approved taxi	"N123CD approved taxi to runway 25."
push back tow truck	"Ground, N456EF ready for pushback, tow truck standing by."
push back tow bar	"N789GH requesting pushback with tow bar attached."

2. Emergencies & Abnormal Situations

Engine & Systems Failures

Term	Example Phrase
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engine stall	"MAYDAY, N123AB engine stall, immediate return!"
loss of thrust	"PAN-PAN, N456CD loss of thrust in engine two!"
loss of power	"MAYDAY, N789EF complete loss of power!"
we lost engine number 1	"Tower, N234GH lost engine number one!"
flame out on the right engine	"Center, N567IJ right engine flame out!"
an engine flame out	"N890KL declaring emergency, engine flame out!"
engine low oil pressure	"PAN-PAN, N123MN engine one, low oil pressure!"
engine high temperature	"N456OP engine two, high temperature!"
high oil temperature	"N789QR high oil temperature in engine one!"
low oil pressure	"N234ST low oil pressure alert!"
engine surge	"N567UV experiencing engine surge!"
hydraulic fluid leak	"MAYDAY, N890WX hydraulic fluid leak!"
hydraulic pressure indication is dropping	"PAN-PAN, N123YZ hydraulic pressure decreasing!"
total electrical failure	"MAYDAY, N456AB total electrical failure!"

battery power	"N789CD switching to battery power!"
partial panel	"N234EF flying partial panel!"
FMS went blank	"N567GH FMS failure!"
GPS inoperative	"N890IJ GPS navigation lost!"
electronic navigation capability	"N123KL electronic nav systems inoperative!"
neither of propellers is working	"MAYDAY, N456MN both propellers feathered!"

Landing Gear Issues

Term	Example Phrase
main gear is stuck	"Tower, N789OP main gear stuck!"
landing gear stuck	"PAN-PAN, N234QR landing gear unsafe!"
landing gear bugged down	"N567ST landing gear unsafe indication!"
left main landing gear	"MAYDAY, N890UV left main gear issue!"
main landing gear collapsed	"Emergency, main gear collapsed!"
main landing gear retracted	"N456YZ gear retraction failure!"
main landing gear twisted	"N789AB right main gear twisted!"

main landing gear extended	"Tower, N234CD all gear down and locked!"
wheels up landing	"Preparing for wheels-up landing!"
belly landing	"Executing belly landing!"
flaps up landing	"Preparing for flaps-up landing!"

Pressurization & Decompression

Term	Example Phrase
air cabin depressurization	"MAYDAY, rapid decompression!"
sudden decompression	"PAN-PAN, sudden decompression!"
due to pressurization problem	"Requesting lower altitude, pressurization issue!"

Fire & Smoke

Term	Example Phrase
fire in the hold	"MAYDAY, fire in cargo hold!"
fire on board	"Emergency, fire in cabin!"
fire in the wheel well	"MAYDAY, smoke in wheel well!"
fire in the catering	"PAN-PAN, galley fire!"

uncontrollable fire	"MAYDAY, uncontrollable fire!"
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smoke in the cabin	"Emergency, smoke in the cabin!"
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fumes in the cabin	"PAN-PAN, strong fumes in the cockpit!"
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Structural Damage

Term

Example Phrase

door separated from the airplane	"MAYDAY, cargo door separated!"
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broken windshield	"Emergency, windshield cracked!"
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cracked windshield	"Reporting cracked windshield!"
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cracked windscreen	"PAN-PAN, windscreen cracked!"
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shattered windscreen	"MAYDAY, windscreen shattered!"
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windscreen damaged	"Windscreen damage from bird strike!"
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it is opened in the front	"Emergency, forward cargo door open!"
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it is opened in the aft cargo hold	"PAN-PAN, aft cargo door open!"
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it is opened in the forward cargo hold	"Forward cargo door warning light!"
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Weather-Related Emergencies

Term	Example Phrase
thunderstorm	"PAN-PAN, severe thunderstorm!"
severe turbulence	"MAYDAY, severe turbulence!"
moderate turbulence	"Experiencing moderate turbulence!"
windshear on final	"Windshear alert on final!"
microburst on final	"MAYDAY, microburst encounter!"
gust wind on final approach	"Severe gusty winds on final!"
icing conditions	"PAN-PAN, severe icing!"
de-icing system not working	"De-icing system failure!"

Fuel Issues

Term	Example Phrase
dump some fuel	"MAYDAY, requesting fuel dump!"
request fuel dumping	"Requesting fuel dumping area!"
facing low fuel	"PAN-PAN, low fuel state!"
facing fuel starvation	"MAYDAY, fuel starvation imminent!"

confirm fuel remaining in hours	"Confirming 1.5 hours of fuel remaining!"
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Other Emergencies

Term	Example Phrase
distress call	"MAYDAY MAYDAY MAYDAY!"
emergency evacuation	"Preparing for emergency evacuation!"
emergency landing	"Executing emergency landing!"
perform an emergency landing	"Performing emergency landing!"
emergency services	"Requesting emergency services!"
escapes slides accidentally deployed	"PAN-PAN, escape slide deployed!"
struck by lightning	"Struck by lightning!"
bird strike	"MAYDAY, bird strike!"
hit birds	"Hit multiple birds!"
flock of birds on final	"Large flock of birds on final!"
vultures in the vicinity	"Vultures near runway threshold!"

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3. Passenger & Crew Incidents

Medical Emergencies

Term	Example Phrase
a person passed out	"PAN-PAN, passenger unconscious, need medical assistance"
the flight attendant has fainted	"Crew member incapacitated, need paramedics"
heart attack	"MAYDAY, suspected heart attack onboard"
seizure	"PAN-PAN, passenger having seizure"
epileptic attack	"Epileptic emergency, diverting to nearest airport"
pilot incapacitated	"MAYDAY, captain incapacitated, FO assuming control"
pilot incapacitation	"Declaring emergency, pilot medical emergency"
food poisoning	"PAN-PAN, multiple cases of food poisoning"

Passenger Behavior

Term	Example Phrase

passenger fighting on board	"MAYDAY, unruly passenger situation"
passenger misbehavior	"PAN-PAN, disruptive passenger restrained"
passengers misconduct	"Reporting passenger misconduct"
unaccompanied minor	"Requesting escort for unaccompanied minor"

Crew Communications

Term	Example Phrase
flight attendant	"Cabin crew to flight deck, medical emergency"
flight purser	"Purser reporting cabin preparations complete"
stewardess	"Stewardess requesting pilot assistance"

4. Ground Operations & Airport Incidents

Ground Handling

Term	Example Phrase
towed	"Ready to be towed to maintenance hangar"

disembark passengers	"Requesting stairs for passenger disembarkation"
give way to the aircraft	"Give way to taxiing B747"
got stuck	"Stuck in soft ground off taxiway"
maintenance people are on the way	"Maintenance technician en route"
ground staff on the way	"Ground crew dispatched to gate"
fire fighters are on the way	"Fire trucks responding to location"
airport authority	"Requesting airport authority representative"
work in progress	"Construction work near taxiway"
debris on the taxiway	"FOD observed on taxiway"
wreckage on the RWY	"Aircraft debris on runway"
FOD was reported	"FOD reported on ramp area"
drone near the airport	"Drone sighting north of airfield"
collision with a tow truck	"MAYDAY, wingtip collision with tow vehicle"
loose dog on board	"PAN-PAN, escaped pet in cabin"
Parking & Startup	

Term	Example Phrase
return to the parking	"Returning to parking due to technical issue"
start up at 60	"Requesting startup at 60 minutes past hour"
start up and pushback approved	"Cleared for startup and pushback"
operations closed	"Airport operations closed until 0600Z"

5. Navigation & Communication

Radio & Transmission Issues

Term	Example Phrase
radar contact lost	"Radar contact lost, switching to HF"
radio contact lost	"MAYDAY, lost radio contact, squawking 7600"
loss of radio contact	"PAN-PAN, complete radio failure"
transmission is readable	"Your transmission readable 5 by 5"
transmission is poor	"Your transmission barely readable"
readability is poor	"Readability poor, say again slowly"

transmission is blocked	"Your transmission blocked by other traffic"
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message was blocked	"Please repeat last message"
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message was garbled	"Say again, transmission garbled"
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Navigation Procedures

Term	Example Phrase
under visual meteorological conditions	"Maintaining VMC at 5,500 feet"
under radar vectors	"On your vectors to final"
expect RNAV approach	"Expect RNAV Z approach runway 28R"
TOD (top of descent) is close	"Approaching TOD point"
confirm ETA	"Request confirmation of estimated arrival"
confirm diversion	"Confirming diversion to alternate"
confirm deviation	"Confirming weather deviation approved"
confirm detour due to bad weather	"Confirming reroute for weather"
deviation to avoid weather	"PAN-PAN, deviating for weather"
restricted area	"Requesting clearance through restricted area"

military activity	"Military exercise in progress"
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Instrumentation Issues

Term	Example Phrase
altimeter setting	"Request current altimeter setting"
disagreement in the altimeters	"PAN-PAN, altimeter disagreement"
rate of descent	"Establishing 500 fpm descent"
present heading	"Maintaining present heading 270"

6. Weather & Environmental Conditions

Weather Reports & Advisories

Term	Example Phrase
shower over the field	"ATIS reports light shower"
weather is deteriorating rapidly	"Warning, conditions deteriorating"
expect moderate turbulence	"PIREP, moderate turbulence at FL320"
expect severe turbulence	"Urgent PIREP, severe turbulence"

Visual Observations

Term	Example Phrase
hot air balloon at 12 o'clock	"Traffic alert, balloon 12 o'clock"
hot air balloon at 12 o'clock	"Correction, balloon at 12 o'clock"

7. Cargo & Special Situations

Cargo Operations

Term	Example Phrase
cargo apron	"Proceeding to cargo apron"
dangerous goods on board	"Declaring dangerous goods as per manifest"
hazmat on board	"PAN-PAN, hazmat cargo category 3"
human organ for transplant	"Priority, carrying human organ"

Aircraft Weight & Balance

Term	Example Phrase
number of persons on board	"Declaring 145 souls on board"

confirm people on board	"Confirming 87 passengers and 5 crew"
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confirm souls on board	"MAYDAY, confirming 203 souls"
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8. General Aviation & Miscellaneous

Balloon Operations

Term	Example Phrase
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hot air balloon	"Traffic, balloon drifting northeast"
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Pilot Reports & Requests

Term	Example Phrase
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need assistance	"PAN-PAN, needing ATC assistance"
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assistance upon arrival	"Requesting medical assistance"
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at your discretion	"Climb at your discretion"
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confirm intentions	"Please confirm your intentions"
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confirm if the approach is adequate	"Confirm visual approach approved"
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be advised	"Be advised, wake turbulence"
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say indicated airspeed

"Say indicated airspeed"

copied you lost ailerons

"Copied, lost aileron control"

read back all information

"Please read back clearance"

check out the problem

"Maintenance checking issue"

looks like I have a failure

"PAN-PAN, hydraulic failure"

we are assessing the system

"Assessing electrical system"
